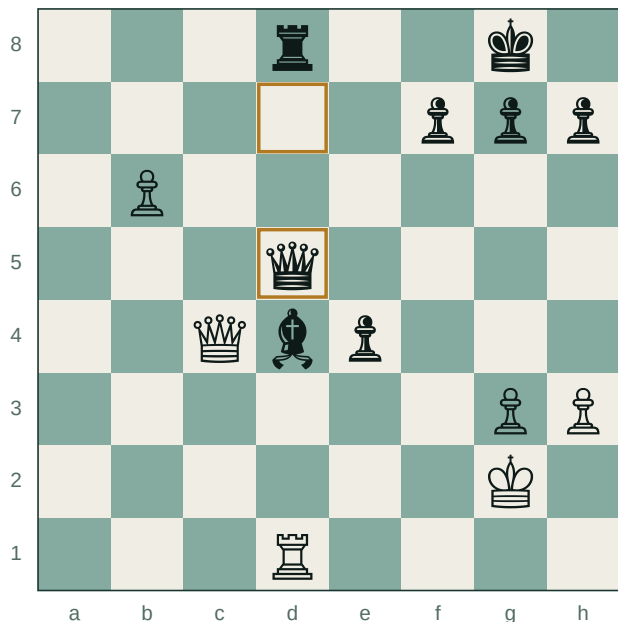


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 35

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Qd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qxd5 Rxd5 36. b7 Rb5 37. Rxd4

35.Qxd5 The queen captures the queen on d5. From d5 it attacks rook on d8 and bishop on d4. Recorded reply: **35...Rxd5**.

36.b7 The pawn moves from b6 to b7. Recorded reply: **36...Rb5**.

37.Rxd4 The rook captures the bishop on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -4 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.